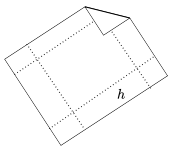
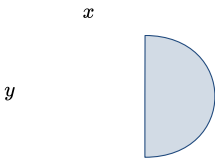
1.35 Differentiation: Optimisation

Chapter 12 · Original slide 70 · Optimisation Problems/Modelling



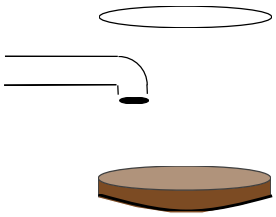
We have a sheet of A4 paper, which we want to fold into a cuboid. What height should we choose for the cuboid in order to maximise the volume?



These are examples of optimisation problems: we're trying to maximise/minimise some quantity by choosing an appropriate value of a variable that we can control.

We have 50m of fencing, and want to make a bear pen of the following shape, such that the area is maximised. What should we choose x and y to be?

Chapter 12 · Original slide 71 · 'Rate of change'



Up to now we've had y in terms of x, where $\frac{dy}{dx}$ means "the rate at which y changes with respect to x".

But we can use similar gradient function notation for other physical quantities.

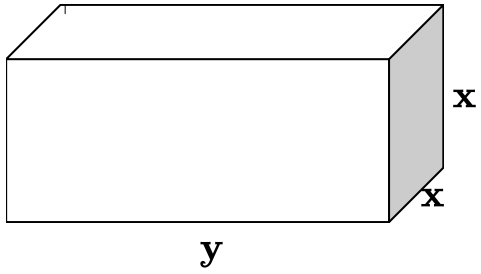
Real Life Maths!

A sewage container fills at a rate of 20 cm3 per second.

How could we use appropriate notation to represent this?

1.35 Differentiation: Optimisation

Chapter 12 · Original slide 72 · Example Optimisation Problem



Optimisation problems in an exam usually follow the following pattern:

• There are 2 variables involved (you may have to introduce one yourself), typically lengths.

• There are expressions for two different physical quantities:

• One is a constraint, e.g. “the surface area is 20cm2”.

• The other we wish to maximise/minimise, e.g. “we wish to maximise the volume”.

• We use the constraint to eliminate one of the variables in the latter equation, so that it is then just in terms of one variable, and we can then use differentiation to find the turning point.

[Textbook] A large tank in the shape of a cuboid is to be made from 54m2 of sheet metal. The tank has a horizontal base and no top. The height of the tank is x metres. Two of the opposite vertical faces are squares.

a) Show that the volume, V m3, of the tank is given by

$V = 18x - \frac{2}{3}x^3$.

These are the two equations mentioned in the guidance: one for surface area and one volume.

We need to introduce a second variable ourselves so that we can find expressions for the surface area and volume.

Once we have the ‘optimal’ value of x, we sub it back into V to get the best possible volume.

b) Given that x can vary, use differentiation to find the maximum or minimum value of V.

Chapter 12 · Original slide 73 · Test Your Understanding

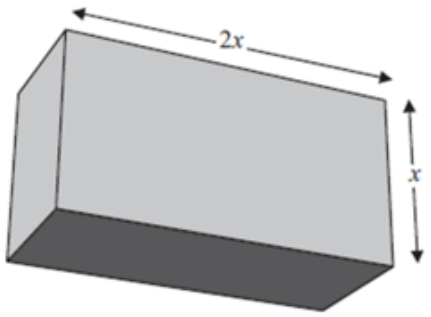


Figure 2

A cuboid has a rectangular cross-section where the length of the rectangle is equal to twice its width, x cm, as shown in Figure 2.

The volume of the cuboid is 81 cubic centimetres.

(a) Show that the total length, L cm, of the twelve edges of the cuboid is given by

$L = 12x + \frac{162}{x^2}$.

(3)

(b) Use calculus to find the minimum value of L. (6)

(c) Justify, by further differentiation, that the value of L that you have found is a minimum. (2)

1.35 Differentiation: Optimisation

Chapter 12 · Original slide 74 · Exercise 12K – Pearson Pure Y1 page 81

6 A rectangular garden is fenced on three sides, and the house forms the fourth side of the rectangle.

a Given that the total length of the fence is $80\,\text{m}$, show that the area, A, of the garden is given by the formula $A = y(80 - 2y)$, where y is the distance from the house to the end of the garden.

b Given that the area is a maximum for this length of fence, find the dimensions of the enclosed garden, and the area which is enclosed.

Chapter 12 · Original slide 75 · Exercise 12K – Pearson Pure Y1 page 81

7 A closed cylinder has total surface area equal to 600π.
a Show that the volume, $V\,\text{cm}^3$, of this cylinder is given by the formula $V = 300\pi r - \pi r^3$, where $r\,\text{cm}$ is the radius of the cylinder.
b Find the maximum volume of such a cylinder.

1.35 Differentiation: Optimisation

Chapter 12 · Original slide 76 · Exercise 12K – Pearson Pure Y1 page 81

9 A shape consists of a rectangular base with a semicircular top, as shown.
a Given that the perimeter of the shape is 40 cm, show that its area, A cm^2, is given by the formula
$A = 40r - 2r^2 - \frac{\pi r^2}{2}$
where r cm is the radius of the semicircle. (2 ma
b Hence find the maximum value for the area of the shape. (4 ma



9 A shape consists of a rectangular base with a semicircular top, as shown.

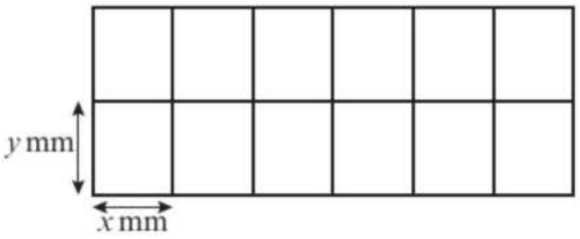
a Given that the perimeter of the shape is $40\,\text{cm}$, show that its area, $A\,\text{cm}^2$, is given by the formula

$$A = 40r - 2r^2 - \frac{\pi r^2}{2}$$

where $r\,\text{cm}$ is the radius of the semicircle. (2 marks)

b Hence find the maximum value for the area of the shape. (4 marks)

Chapter 12 · Original slide 77 · Exercise 12K – Pearson Pure Y1 page 81



10 The shape shown is a wire frame in the form of a large rectangle split by parallel lengths of wire into 12 smaller equal-sized rectangles.

a Given that the total length of wire used to complete the whole frame is $1512\,\text{mm}$, show that the area of the whole shape, $A\,\text{mm}^2$, is given by the formula

$$A = 1296x - \frac{108x^2}{7}$$

where $x\,\text{mm}$ is the width of one of the smaller rectangles. (4 marks)

b Hence find the maximum area which can be enclosed in this way. (4 marks)